

ALCHEMIZE RESOURCE LIBRARY · BUSINESS OPERATIONS

Business Operations & Systems Workbook

A practical operational audit -- find where work gets lost, who really owns each process, and what to fix first.

USE THIS WORKBOOK TO

- ◆ Score how reliable each part of the business actually is today
- ◆ Find the handoffs where work quietly gets lost
- ◆ See which systems overlap, cost money, or depend on one person
- ◆ Leave with a ranked, three-item fix list

ESTIMATED TIME
30-40 minutes

HAVE NEARBY
A list of the software and vendors you currently pay for, if you have one

A process is reliable when it has a clear owner, a known trigger, a defined home for information, and a plan for what happens when the usual owner is unavailable.



01 BUSINESS SNAPSHOT

START HERE

Answer these as they actually are today, not as you would like them to be. The gap between the two is what this workbook is for.

Field	Current picture
Business stage / team size	
Primary products or services	
Current operational pain points and top priorities	

02 OPERATIONAL HEALTH SCORE

Rate each area from 1 (mostly manual or unclear) to 5 (documented, owned, and repeatable).

Area	1	2	3	4	5	Note
Organization	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Documentation	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Financial administration	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Customer workflow	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Recurring task management	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

Watch for

Information entered more than once, tasks depending on memory, records in personal accounts, or missing follow-up are common signs a process needs structure.

Which area scored lowest, and did that surprise you?

Records and administration

The goal here is not to store everything. It is to decide what matters enough to have a defined place, an accountable owner, appropriate access, and a retention decision.

01 RECORD INVENTORY

Record area	Where stored?	Owner	Current?	Missing / follow-up
Company and governance				
Financial and tax				
Insurance and risk				
Clients / customers				
Vendors / contractors				
Agreements, licenses, and policies				

02 RECORD HEALTH CHECK

- ☐ Can the latest version be found in under two minutes?
- ☐ Is access appropriate for the person who needs it?
- ☐ Is there a backup or safe alternate location?
- ☐ Is ownership clear when someone is unavailable?
- ☐ Is the record still needed, or does it have a review/archive plan?

Which record is hardest to find quickly, and which category depends on one person?

A usable record system

A record has a reliable home, an accountable owner, appropriate access, a retention decision, and a way to confirm the current version is complete.

Recurring responsibilities

Operational reliability usually breaks down where recurring work is not scheduled, owned, or checked. This page separates recurring obligations from one-off problems, so nothing routine is quietly running on memory.

01 RECURRING RESPONSIBILITY CALENDAR

Responsibility	Owner	Frequency	Backup person	Status
Bookkeeping review		Monthly		
Payroll / contractor review				
Invoicing / receivables				
Tax or filing deadlines				
License / vendor renewals				
Insurance renewal		Annual		

02 CADENCE NOTES

Weekly and monthly responsibilities

Quarterly and annual responsibilities

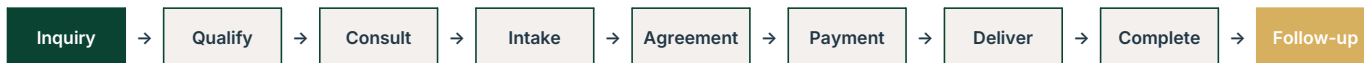
The fail-safe question

If the normal owner is unavailable this week, what happens to this task? A responsibility with no backup is still a weak point, even if it has never failed yet.

Client and internal workflows

A business usually has more friction at the handoff points -- where work moves between people, systems, or steps -- than in the work itself. This page maps the handoffs, not just the tasks.

01 WORKFLOW MAP



02 HANDOFF ANALYSIS

LOOK FOR

A handoff with no clear confirmation step is where work quietly stalls. If nobody explicitly marks it "received," assume it sometimes gets missed.

Handoff point	From	To	What confirms it moved	Risk if missed
Inquiry to consultation				
Agreement to payment				
Payment to service start				
Service to document delivery				
Completion to follow-up				

03 FRICTION SIGNALS

- ☐ Work starts before agreement or payment is confirmed
- ☐ Status questions repeat because nobody knows the current state
- ☐ Files live in email or a personal account instead of a shared system
- ☐ One person is the only one who understands a process

Digital system inventory

Technology should support operations, not add another layer of confusion. For each system, ask whether it is still doing real work, whether the cost is known, and whether the business -- not just one person -- actually owns it.

01 SYSTEM INVENTORY

System	Provider / owner	Cost / renewal	Issue	Keep / replace / review
Website / domain / email				
CRM / customer records				
Cloud storage / forms				
Bookkeeping / payments				
Password / access management				
Automation, reporting, backups				

02 COST AND ACCESS CHECK

- ☐ Is this system still used regularly, by more than one task?
- ☐ Does it duplicate another tool or workflow already in use?
- ☐ Is the renewal date known and documented somewhere other than memory?
- ☐ Is the account business-owned, with business billing?
- ☐ Is recovery access available to an authorized backup person?
- ☐ Could the business keep operating if the current owner left tomorrow?

Account ownership

Core business systems should not depend solely on an employee, contractor, or former vendor's personal account. Confirm business-controlled ownership, recovery, billing, and backup access for each one.

Priority action plan

This page turns the assessment into a sequence, not a long list. A good first fix is specific, addresses a real risk or repeated delay, and has a single owner who will know when it is actually done.

01 REFLECTION

What creates the most friction, or is easiest to overlook day to day?

What information is duplicated, or what process depends entirely on one person's memory?

02 SORT WHAT NEEDS ATTENTION

Weigh urgency against effort

	Low effort	High effort
High impact	Do this first	Plan and schedule
Low impact	Quick win, low stakes	Deprioritize

03 FIRST THREE FIXES

Priority	Action	Owner	Deadline	Status
1				
2				
3				

Why this first

The first fix should usually address a real risk, a repeated delay, or a missing owner -- and it should be specific enough that everyone will agree when it is actually done.

Before you close this workbook

You now have a scored picture of where the business stands, a map of the handoffs that create friction, a system inventory, and three ranked fixes with owners and dates. That is the difference between "things feel disorganized" and knowing exactly what to do about it.

What surprised you most while completing this workbook?

Revisit this quarterly

Operations change as a business grows. A recurring responsibility that had a clear owner at five clients may not still have one at fifty. Set a reminder to run this assessment again.

NEXT STEP

YOU FOUND THE FRICTION. LET'S BUILD THE FIX.

Need help turning this audit into a working system? Schedule a consultation at getalchemize.com.

getalchemize.com

This workbook provides general operational guidance. It is not a cybersecurity audit, managed IT service, legal review, compliance certification, or guarantee of business performance.